

and transition risks could impact capital provisioning and credit loss estimates. The findings have been fed into its internal capital adequacy assessment process (ICAAP).

A framework for sustainable financing has been formulated to guide green, social, sustainable, and sustainable-linked lending. ICICI Bank has taken inputs from the government's Framework for Sovereign Green Bonds issued in December 2022. The framework specifies the el-

igibility criteria, applicable due diligence requirements, and the verification process for sustainable finance.

On the business side, the bank is also supporting the development of new technologies like hydrogen fuel, and battery storage systems through financing. The lender's green financing portfolio stood at ₹19,366 crore as of March 2024, of which 50% was for financing renewable energy.

Internally, the bank has set a target to become carbon neutral in Scope

1 and Scope 2 emissions by FY32, as an interim step towards reducing the bank's carbon footprint. Under the leadership of Sandeep Bakhshi, MD & CEO, ICICI Bank, the lender is using recycled paper, cutting down plastic, and installing atmospheric water generators that can produce up to 8,000 litres of drinking water per day directly from the atmosphere.

The bank isn't only focused on the immediate impact. It's laying the groundwork for deeper ESG integration in the years to come. A key part of this future readiness is data governance. "The bank is onboarding a digital tool with capabilities to calculate greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions across all categories specified in the GHG Protocol and to also monitor the roadmap and targets to manage the bank's carbon footprint," the spokesperson says.

True sustainability is not just about systems and frameworks—it's also about people. ICICI Bank is ensuring that its workforce is ESG-ready. The bank has initiated training and awareness programmes for employees and management, leveraging both internal experts and external institutions. ICICI Bank's commitment extends well beyond its business line. In FY24, the bank spent more than ₹519 crore on CSR activities, according to Primeinfobase. | 39

ICICI Bank in the annual report FY24 said, "The CSR initiatives span the thematic areas of healthcare, environment, supporting livelihood and community development. These include both large-scale projects as well as granular initiatives under the thematic areas spread across the country. Sustainability and scalability of projects are key pillars. The bank estimates that its CSR initiatives have benefited over 12 million people thus far." **BT**

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